

IMPACT Competitive Selling Framework (CSF)

Introductory Primer



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For internal training only.

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The IMPACT Competitive Selling Framework

Overview

The IMPACT Competitive Selling Framework (CSF) is a simplified way to create a high-value customer experience through **compelling** and **impactful** two-way dialogue. It integrates organizational priorities and learnings into a compact, precise framework that is easily adopted and adaptable to the local marketplace.

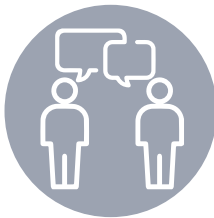
Objectives

- After reading this primer, you will be able to recall the 4 core steps of the IMPACT CSF and identify the key actions necessary to take to accomplish each step.
- Following completion of the IMPACT CSF training, you will be able to implement and execute these concepts.
- Additionally, to help reinforce the IMPACT CSF training, you will explore the model in greater depth with auxiliary Guidebooks and Workshops, tailored to the following specific roles:

Marketing



Selling



Coaching



Designed for the Current Market Landscape

Customers are challenged with making complex treatment decisions in a rapidly changing and competitive healthcare environment. The IMPACT CSF is adaptable to the evolving healthcare landscape and offers a simplified framework to guide interactions:

The Complex Healthcare Marketplace

- Evolving healthcare delivery
- Focus on patient/customer-centric, value-based healthcare
- Increasing competition
- Limited physician access
- Digital/omni-channel engagements

Simplified Selling Framework

- Patient/customer-centric approach
- Competitive mindset
- Aligned with marketing strategy and messaging
- Executable and adaptable



The IMPACT Competitive Selling Framework

What Does the IMPACT CSF Look Like?

The IMPACT CSF is based on 3 guiding principles:

- **Keeping a central focus** on the patient's and/or customer's unmet needs or challenges
- **Engaging customers** through insight-driven storytelling
- **Driving incremental changes** in customer thinking and decision-making

It encompasses the entire omni-channel sales process from pre-call planning to post-call analysis and incorporates omni-channel activity planning to ensure the delivery of targeted messages to the right HCP at the right time.

Keeping a Central Focus on the Patient and/or Customer

In the modern healthcare environment, decisions are made based on clinical evidence, the patient's medical history, and treatment journey.

The IMPACT CSF requires insight into and understanding of customer and patient unmet needs or challenges. An elevated awareness of the treatment journey and desired treatment/patient outcomes is key to fostering compelling emotive connections.



Engaging Using Customer Insights

A customer insight is an understanding of a customer's beliefs and behavior. Insight selling involves integrating market data and data from customer observations to deepen awareness of the reasoning behind customer attitudes, biases, and behaviors.

Successful sales representatives tailor selling interactions to each unique customer and use insight-driven storytelling to engage their customer in a high-value, two-way dialogue.

Driving Incremental Changes in Customer Thinking and Behaviors to Achieve a Good Sell Outcome (GSO)

In a successful customer change journey, the ultimate objective is to achieve a GSO.

This requires the identification of incremental steps and shifts in customer beliefs and behaviors. By understanding a customer's current beliefs and behaviors, you can identify the incremental steps needed to achieve shifts along the customer change journey from the current state toward the desired state, ultimately achieving a GSO commitment.



The IMPACT Competitive Selling Framework



COCO, or the commercial-oriented call objective, represents the pre-call planning step. This is where customer insights are used to identify the customer persona, as well as the call objective that includes the incremental steps to achieve a GSO. When preparing your COCO, identify a select patient type to align on and develop thought-provoking questions that will challenge status quo thinking and encourage the customer to do differently.



Anchor opens the conversation using the insights identified in the COCO to create a patient-focused narrative and align with the customer on the call objective. Using a competitive mindset, messaging is tailored to the customer by focusing on an appropriate patient-type and/or customer challenge/unmet need. A story anchors the conversation and ensures discussions remain on topic.



Engage builds off the Anchor to draw the customer in by allowing them the opportunity to respond and ask questions. Through a compelling and impactful two-way dialogue, the Engage step allows you to connect clinical data and product messages as an appropriate solution to address customer/patient needs and handle potential customer objections.



Close is the process of gaining customer agreement and commitment through clearly defined next steps that are aligned to the call objective and advance the customer journey (incremental steps) to ultimately achieve a GSO. Omni-channel activities should be considered as a follow-up to extend the customer engagement beyond Face-to-Face or Screen-to-Screen interactions. After the Close of each call, all new insights gained from the call should be recorded to inform future call objectives.

Commercial-Oriented Call Objective

COCO: Commercial-Oriented Call Objective

The COCO is the first and last phase of a sales call. It's the planning and evaluating step of the IMPACT CSF, building from actions agreed upon during previous calls.

A COCO is a specific call objective/strategy focused on achieving a GSO by incrementally moving a customer from a current belief and behavior to a desired belief and behavior.

To create an effective COCO, it is important to ask yourself:

- “Where is my customer now, and why? Have I validated this?”
- “Where do I want my customer to be at the end of our call?” (beliefs and behaviors)
- How do I respectfully challenge the customer's status-quo thinking to drive change (do differently)?



How to Develop an Effective COCO

Preparing an effective call strategy requires using the insights and resources available to understand current customer beliefs and behaviors. Customer insights can be gathered from:

- Insights and customer persona tools provided by Marketing
- Sales data
- Past experience
- Input from other stakeholders

The next step is to identify the desired customer belief or behavior, as well as a specific call objective that includes the incremental step(s) needed to achieve a GSO.

Other critical steps in the call strategy include aligning on the selected patient type and patient/customer unmet needs and preparing questions to challenge current customer thinking.

After the call, conduct a post-call evaluation to determine if the call objective was achieved, and to plan follow-up actions.



Establishing the commercial call objective & execution plan



Actions for COCO

- Utilize insights to determine the customer persona (current beliefs/behaviors)
- Identify an appropriate patient and/or patient type
- Identify customer needs and opportunities
- Identify potential roadblocks or barriers (objections)
- Identify the incremental step(s) required to reach the commercial objective and achieve desired behavior (**do differently**)
- Draft a thought-provoking story tailored to the customer to act as your Anchor
- Prepare thought-provoking questions that will help to gain insights, challenge thinking, and foster meaningful two-way dialogue

Anchor

I've Planned My COCO, What's Next?

Once you've established the COCO and developed the pre-call plan, it is time to engage in a customer call.

The Anchor opens the call by sharing the call-plan objective with the customer. The discussion should be focused on a relevant patient type, and probing questions should be used to uncover insights and understand customer challenges and needs.

Like a boat, a conversation without an anchor risks drifting endlessly, severely impacting the quality of the call.

How to Develop an Effective Anchor

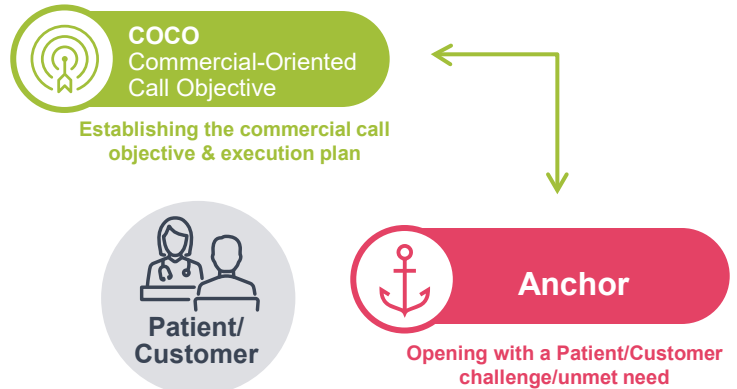
Ultimately, an Anchor should:

- Align with the customer on your call objective
- Focus the customer on an appropriate patient type
- Quickly capture attention and foster an emotive connection to the patient or customer challenge
- Create an engaging two-way dialogue that is relevant to the customer's needs

A perfect Anchor utilizes a thought-provoking patient narrative that fosters an emotive connection between the customer and their patient's needs and/or challenges.

To create a two-way dialogue, use insightful probing questions to uncover insights and challenge a customer's current beliefs and behaviors. Through questioning, you can also explore the negative implications of inaction and/or the potential benefits of an alternative approach/solution.

Effective questioning allows for the creation of progressively stronger Anchors with each subsequent call.



Actions for Anchor

- Share call-plan objective with customer
- Align and anchor your dialogue on an appropriate patient type and patient or customer challenges
- Utilize emotive balance when connecting to a thought-provoking patient narrative during discussions with customers.
- Utilize insightful and challenging questions to:
 - Gain understanding of the customer and patient needs
 - Challenge the customer's current thinking by identifying and exploring the negative implications of inaction
- Build a case for change by expanding customer's thinking with questions that highlight the potential positive outcomes of an alternative approach/solution

Engage

Building a Case for Change

The Engage phase involves executing high-value customer interactions through compelling and impactful two-way dialogue.

This is where you tailor the conversation to connect clinical data and product messages as an appropriate solution, to address customer/patient needs based on the customer persona.

When engaging customers, use a conversational approach to identify objections and/or concerns and handle them appropriately, using the APECT* objection handling approach, to achieve the identified call objective.

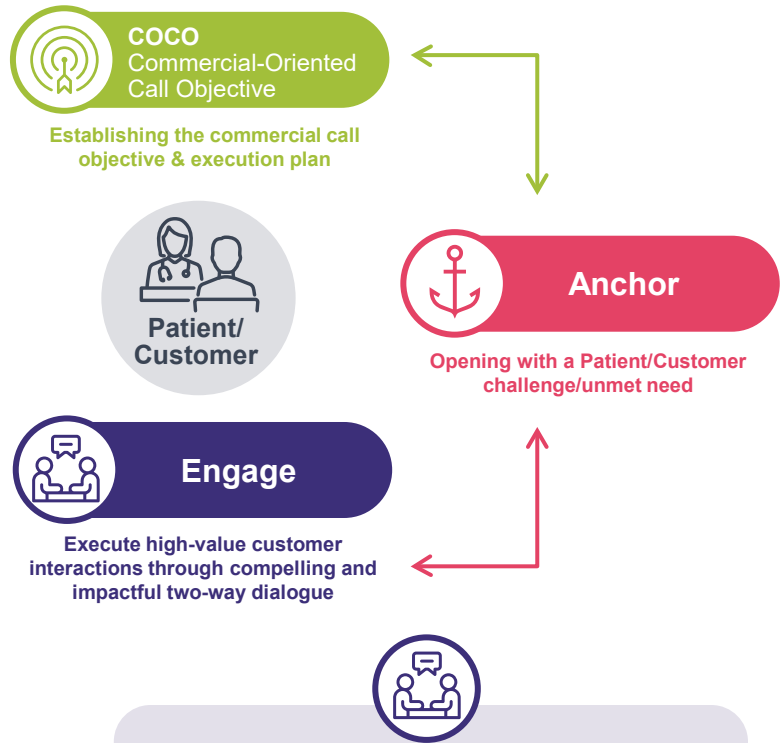
*APECT stands for Acknowledge, Probe, Answer, Confirm, and Transition.

How to Engage Customers

During the Engage phase, be sure to:

- Utilize emotive balance to create connection to the patient
- Use active listening to gain a better understanding of the needs of the customer/patient
- Identify and explore the negative implications of inaction
- Expand customer thinking with questions that highlight the potential positive outcomes of a new approach
- Present solutions that connect clinical data and brand messages to patient and customer challenges

Customers may disengage from the conversation due to an objection or a concern. If this happens, address the concern using the APECT objection handling approach to effectively transition the call back to the call objective.



Actions for Engage

- Engage in active listening and create a two-way dialogue
- Deliver a compelling message (ie, the data that support the benefit of taking a new approach)
- Competitively position the product appropriately
- Effectively connect customers to the right resources
- Connect clinical data and approved messages as an appropriate solution to address the patient and customer challenges
- Identify objections and handle them appropriately to achieve the identified call objective (APECT Objection Handling Approach)
- Avoid data dumping—this will hinder customer engagement

Close

Finishing Strong

Successfully achieving a GSO requires ending each customer interaction with a close for agreement and a specific, actionable commitment for action. Establish clearly defined next steps aligned to the call objective to promote a behavioral change. Consider omni-channel activities to extend the customer engagement beyond face-to-face or screen-to-screen interactions.



How to Effectively Close

At the end of the call, gain agreement from the customer on the specific commitment identified during the call, and confirm your commitment to following up. Agree on next steps.

The Return to COCO/Next Best Action

After the Close stage, the COCO cycle repeats with the next best action. After each call, conduct a post-call analysis and record all new insights gained from the call to inform your next pre-call plan (COCO). Additionally, make sure to use the insights gained to plan out omni-channel engagements/activities with your customer.



Actions for Close

- Close on an insight or patient solution
- Ensure to gain a specific and actionable commitment that is measurable
- Identify omni-channel activities that will ensure follow-through on the commitment
- Confirm the intended follow-up
- Complete a post-call analysis